

# Jonas Mehtali

PhD Student in Computer-Assisted Interventions

jonas.mht.private@gmail.com · j.mehtali@unistra.fr · jonasx.xyz  
github.com/JonasMht · linkedin.com/in/jonasmehltali · ORCID 0000-0003-3688-7782 · Strasbourg, France  
Languages: French (native), German (native), English (C2, LanguageCert Level 3, 2022)

## SUMMARY

PhD student at ICube (UMR 7357), University of Strasbourg, working with Caroline Essert and Juan Verde on automatic multi-needle planning for percutaneous thermal ablation of liver tumors: multi-needle trajectory optimization, GPU-accelerated ablation simulation, and an ergonomic planning interface. Funded through the ITI HealthTech doctoral program, ED269 MSII.

## EDUCATION

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>PhD in Computer-Assisted Interventions</b>                                                       | 2024 - present |
| ICube, University of Strasbourg / IHU Strasbourg. Supervisors: Pr. Caroline Essert, Dr. Juan Verde. |                |
| <b>MSc in Computer Science, Image and 3D</b>                                                        | 2022 - 2024    |
| University of Strasbourg (M1 12.9/20, M2S1 13.7/20)                                                 |                |
| <b>BSc in Computer Science (CMI engineering track)</b>                                              | 2019 - 2022    |
| University of Strasbourg (14.3/20)                                                                  |                |
| <b>Institut Sainte-Jeanne d'Arc, Mulhouse</b>                                                       | 2016 - 2019    |
| Baccalaureat General (15.4/20), Allgemeine Hochschulreife (German Abitur, 1.2)                      |                |

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                    |
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| <b>PhD Researcher, ICube (IMAGeS) and IHU Strasbourg</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Sep 2024 - present |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Multi-needle trajectory optimization for thermal ablation, comparing exhaustive and learning-based methods with respect to vital anatomical structures</li><li>GPU multi-resolution ablation simulation (HEAT, results under 1 s) and chained Neural Cellular Automata estimators (C-NCA, 476 fps)</li><li>Intraoperative replanning under breathing motion; usability studies with clinical experts</li></ul> |                    |
| <b>End-of-Studies Internship, ICube (IMAGeS) and IHU Strasbourg</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Jan - Aug 2024     |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Real-time thermal ablation simulation with networked GPU compute; mixed-reality co-planning across devices; custom networking protocol with modified Huffman compression</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                    |
| <b>Research Internship, TU Darmstadt (MEC-Lab) and ICube (IMAGeS)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Jun - Sep 2023     |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>CryoTrack cryoablation planning and navigation: breathing-cycle synchronization, EM tracking, real-time needle trajectory correction; phantom studies at CHU Strasbourg; led to a MICCAI 2024 publication</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                            |                    |
| <b>Research Camp, University of Oviedo, Spain</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | May - Jul 2022     |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Full research project from hypothesis to publication; co-authored the resulting PeerJ paper on typeface usability</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                    |
| <b>Research Internship, EOST, University of Strasbourg</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Jun - Jul 2020     |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>Landslide monitoring software (Python/Matplotlib) for the La Valette site, later taken over by an EOST student</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                    |

## PUBLICATIONS AND PATENT

- J. Mehtali**, J. Verde, C. Essert. C-NCA: Chained Neural Cellular Automata for Fast and Accurate Thermal Ablation Estimation. MICCAI 2025, Seoul. DOI 10.1007/978-3-032-04965-0\_7
- J. Mehtali**, J. Verde, C. Essert. HEAT: High-Efficiency Simulation for Thermal Ablation Therapy. IJCARS 2025, 20(6):1135-1143. DOI 10.1007/s11548-025-03350-z
- H.J. Krumb, **J. Mehtali**, J. Verde, A. Mukhopadhyay, C. Essert. Cryotrack: Planning and Navigation for Computer Assisted Cryoablation. MICCAI 2024, Marrakesh. DOI 10.1007/978-3-031-72089-5\_10
- S. Vecino, **J. Mehtali**, J. de Andres, et al. How does serif vs sans serif typeface impact the usability of e-commerce websites? PeerJ Computer Science, 2022. DOI 10.7717/peerj-cs.1139
- Patent: Method and apparatus for determining a thermal ablation volume (J. Mehtali, C. Essert, J. Verde)

## SKILLS

|                        |                                                                                   |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Languages</b>       | Python, C/C++, CUDA                                                               |
| <b>Medical imaging</b> | 3D Slicer, PyTorch, VTK, OpenIGTLink, medical image processing and segmentation   |
| <b>Graphics and XR</b> | OpenGL, Unity, Godot, Blender, Maya, mixed reality (Meta Quest)                   |
| <b>Other</b>           | GPU computing, LLM tooling and automation, project management, scientific writing |

## SHORT POSITIONS

- Caterer and event staff, Service de la Vie Universitaire, University of Strasbourg (2022 - 2024)
- General agent and village shop sales and accounting, Town of Niffer, Haut-Rhin (2020 - 2022)
- IT maintenance intern, Concept Office, Mulhouse (2018)